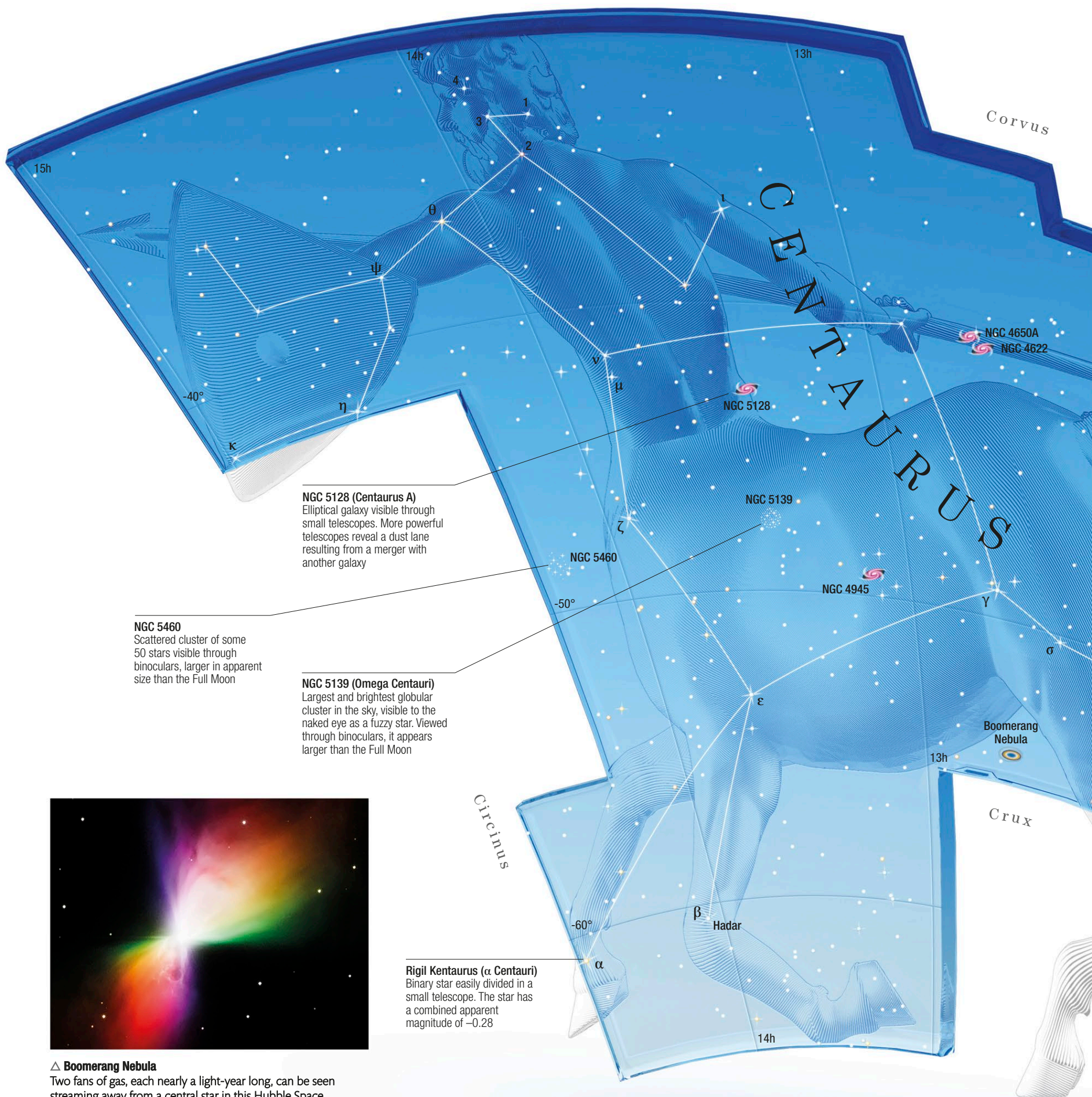


Rigel Kentaurus
1.5 Suns

Theta Centauri
42 Suns

Gamma Centauri
183 Suns

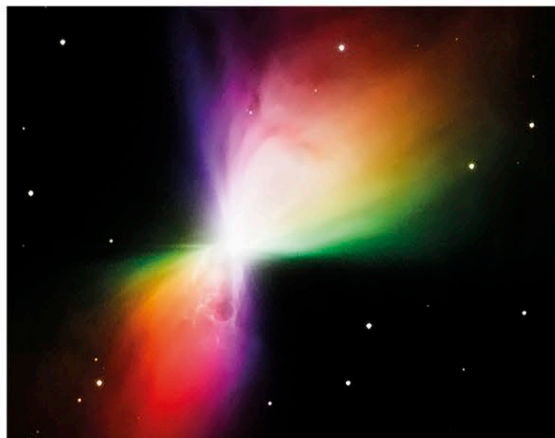


NGC 5128 (Centaurus A)
Elliptical galaxy visible through small telescopes. More powerful telescopes reveal a dust lane resulting from a merger with another galaxy

NGC 5460
Scattered cluster of some 50 stars visible through binoculars, larger in apparent size than the Full Moon

NGC 5139 (Omega Centauri)
Largest and brightest globular cluster in the sky, visible to the naked eye as a fuzzy star. Viewed through binoculars, it appears larger than the Full Moon

Rigel Kentaurus (α Centauri)
Binary star easily divided in a small telescope. The star has a combined apparent magnitude of -0.28



△ Boomerang Nebula

Two fans of gas, each nearly a light-year long, can be seen streaming away from a central star in this Hubble Space Telescope image. Over the past 1,500 years, the central star has lost nearly one and a half times the mass of our Sun. The nebula is named for its appearance through ground-based telescopes.